The model became a great success. Its sales continue to grow, especially in China, by as much as by 173 per cent a year. It won more than 150 global awards and ‘boasts the youngest average customer age in the Jaguar range’.

In 2014, Ratan became the first Indian to be awarded the Knight Grand Cross of the Order of the British Empire (GBE) since India became a republic. Presenting the award on behalf of Queen Elizabeth II, the high commissioner, Sir James Bevan, said that it was ‘conferred by the UK, in recognition of his services to UK-India relations, inward investment to the UK and philanthropy’.

Later in 2015, Ratan was inducted into the hallowed Automotive Hall of Fame, for returning ‘Jaguar and Range Rover to eminent status and profitability, preserving the auto industry in the United Kingdom’. Receiving the award more than three years after he had stepped down as chairman of Tata Motors, he said that he was proud of the significant achievements at Jaguar Land Rover.

He added that the induction in the same year of ‘Roger Penske [a former race car driver, and founder chairman and CEO of the Penske Automotive Group] and Luca [Luca Cordero di Montezemolo, former president of Fiat, Ferrari and Maserati] only added to the importance of the accolade’. He was singularly delighted that he was recognized along with Luca, who was his close friend and president of Italy’s Confindustria industrial confederation.

With the induction into the Hall of Fame, Ratan joined the exclusive club of automotive legends like Henry Ford, the founder of Ford Motor company, and Karl Benz, who built the worlds’ first ‘practical’ automobile that was powered by an internal combustion engine.

Later, Ratan in his characteristic style downplayed his role in the turnaround and said that he could not ‘take too much of the credit’ as it was the ‘people at JLR’ who had ultimately ‘turned the company around’. He added that though he had not lost hope, during the initial years, the ‘morale was down and people were uncertain of their future with Jaguar Land Rover’. There were ‘fears that Tata would likely close one of the three UK plants, and maybe even close everything and move all operations to India’. Ratan stated that all he did was to ‘ensure them that these were erroneous rumours and encouraged employees to focus on working shoulder-to-shoulder to rebuild these two venerable brands, which is exactly what they did’. He added, ‘Today, I’m proud to say that our three UK factories are working seven days a week struggling to meet demand for our products.’